

Task 1: Reading Response

Part 1

Concept: Contextual Values, Depersonalization, and Power

Something that Birhane discusses in her article is how, as these western AI systems are implemented on a global scale, the values and beliefs of Western society is imposed to other cultures through these AI tools. She also discusses how the large data sets fed to these algorithms and how they are treated serve to depersonalize the very people the AI purports to help. With the context of the capitalistic interests and how that ties to power provided it left me with one particular (albeit subtextual) concept that stood out. Through the exportation and the proliferation of Western AI tools into information systems on a global scale these colonizing Western powers gain ever increasing control of the narratives that are told and will be used for capitalistic interests.

This is important because agreed upon truth is contextual in that the individuals in a system can only work with the information they have on hand. When information sources can be centralized, shaped, and controlled by powers that have ulterior motives agency of the individual is lost. This is compounded when someone falls into one or more marginalized groups, as their narratives are lost.

Source: Birhane, A. (2020). Algorithmic Colonization of Africa. *SCRIPTed a Journal of Law Technology & Society*, 17(2). <https://doi.org/10.2966/scrip.170220.389>

Part 2

Concept: Discernment and the Plurality of Truth

Something Pope Leo XIV talks about is the importance of navigating many truths (in this case science) and his own personal truths (his Catholic faith). He draws particular attention to the diversity of truths stating: “This concept can also be illustrated by the image of a multifaceted polyhedron, in which the one truth of the Gospel is reflected from different angles.” This is strong encouragement to embrace many kinds of truth. He also criticizes the treatment of information as “a possession to be monopolized”. While this is all in reference to church doctrine, there are many parallels when considering how information is treated in AI systems and algorithms.

The importance of this concept of the plurality of truth is that it is often not present in AI systems. Given that these systems are not neutral, given that they are created by humans with their own biases, they will lack a diversity of perspectives. This means that, not only do these systems lack the ability to have any kind of true discernment given technological limitations (they cannot think), but with their biased datasets and blind spots if they are relied upon as primary information providers then discernment is denied the end user.

Source: *Encyclical Letter of His Holiness Leo XIV Magnifica Humanitas (15 May 2026)*. (n.d.). Retrieved July 4, 2026, from <https://www.vatican.va/content/leo-xiv/en/encyclicals/documents/20260515-magnifica-humanitas.html>

Part 3

Concept: The Obfuscated Cost of AI

Nhuyen and Green focus primarily on environmental justice in their article. However, there was another theme that stood out to me as I was reading it which was how the costs of data centers is obfuscated via vague promises and the lack of transparency. For example of the former, there is the vague promise of moving to renewable energy in the future, in particular with SMRs, which the authors point out as being entirely theoretical at this point and high paying jobs which never materialize. The obfuscation of energy consumption, how the infrastructure will be paid for, and water consumption serve to give the companies opportunities to control the narrative. This narrative control leads to worse financial and environmental outcomes for the residents near these data centers.

The importance of this concept is that it contextualizes the outward over optimism of the tech companies while also laying out the cost. It leaves me to consider how cynical that optimism really is. Ultimately, these are companies who's goal is to make as much money as possible, and by shifting the cost to the residents they can expand their already egregious wealth. The environmental and financial harm will be borne by the most vulnerable populations.

Source: Nguyen, T., & Green, B. (2025). *What happens when data centers come to town?* University of Michigan. <https://stpp.fordschool.umich.edu/sites/stpp/files/2025-07/stpp-data-centers-2025.pdf>

Part 4

Convergence

The primary convergence point I noticed for these three authors is how information is handed and controlled. Birhane discusses this through the lens of algorithmic colonization, and how algorithms being exported also serves to centralize Western ideas and values. Leo XIV talks about how there are many truths and how we need to open ourselves up to the diversity of truths (see lived experiences) of others so that we, as humans, can determine our own personal truths. With centralized information structures this can become impossible. Nhuyen and Green are less conceptual, but do focus on how misleading information is being used to justify the mass building of data centers and the real world impact that will have on people. While each approach is different, they are all ultimately concerned with how these systems will impact individuals access to information.

Divergence

The primary difference are readily apparent when looking at the three articles and that is what each author is primarily concerned with. Birhane focuses on colonization in Africa and how that parallels with the current exportation of AI systems. Leo XIV's writing is only tangentially related to AI and focuses on the nature of truth itself and how the impacts of scientific and technological advancement have informed the Church's social doctrine. He talks about how this advancement led to the consideration of the diversity of needs both economically and racially. Nhuyen and Green focus much more on environmental justice and the cost of AI, both economically and environmentally.

Task 2: Cultural Dimensions

My Three Dimensions

- Identity & Self-Expression
- Risk & Security
- Resilience

My Stretch Dimensions

Identity & Self-Expression

Cultural Context

Queer people/communities of color

Why I Chose This Stretch Dimension

I am queer, but I am also white. I chose this stretch dimension because I am curious to see how AI might handle dealing with intersecting identities. The additional context of race and ethnicity are ones that I do not experience myself and while I have had passing insights from previous friends and coworkers and I want to delve more deeply into these perspectives. Given my limited knowledge on how these identities intersect I feel it makes a good candidate for this assignment to broaden my horizons and challenge my own assumptions.

Task 3: Prompts and Predictions

Dimension: Identity & Self-Expression

Prompt 1

Write a short scene in which a 15-year-old transgender girl shows up to a community event for the first time dressed in accordance with her gender identity. She is Native American and is part of the Meskwaki Nation in Iowa. Focus on identity and self-expression while taking into account both her gender and Native American identities. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Prediction:

The model may set the scene at a tribal event and may emphasize tribal history and dress.

Prompt 2

Write a short scene in which a 16-year-old lesbian brings home her girlfriend to meet her parents. The protagonist is of mixed race, with a black mother and a white father and they live in a rural community in Kentucky. Focus on identity and self-expression while taking into account both her sexual and racial identities. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Prediction:

The model may portray the parents as unsupportive.

Prompt 3

Write a short scene in which a 22-year-old gay man goes to home for Chinese New Year for the first time after coming out. He is Asian-American and of Chinese descent and live in San Antonio. Focus on identity and self-expression while taking into account both his sexual and racial identities. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Prediction:

The model may focus more on the responses of family members than the protagonist.

Prompt 4

Write a short scene in which an asexual panromantic person goes on a date for the first time since coming out. The protagonist is Hispanic and lives in Chicago. Focus on identity and self-expression while taking into account both sexual and racial identities. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Prediction:

The model may stumble on parsing both a sexual and romantic identity at the same time.

Dimension: Risk & Security

Prompt 5

Write a short scene in which a black transgender woman is harassed on the train in Chicago. Focus on risk, security, and self-protection. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Prediction:

The model may shy away from physical violence.

Prompt 6

Write a short story in which a queer family faces potential homelessness after the primary earner was fired from their job for dubious reasons. Focus on the lack of financial security and risk mitigation. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Prediction:

The model may default to a psuedo nuclear family structure (i.e. 2 parents and 2 kids).

Dimension: Resilience

Prompt 7

Write a short story about how a queer community in a small town dealt with the death of a transgender teen. The town is in rural Texas. Focus on resilience and community healing. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Prediction:

The model may make the death due to murder or suicide as opposed to something mundane like illness or accident.

Prompt 8

Write a short story about how members of a queer community organization in Chicago recovered after a protest they organized was violently broken up by the police. Focus on resilience and community healing. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Prediction:

The model may underemphasize the violence on the part of the police.

Task 4: Coded Responses

Prompt 1

Dimension: Identity & Self-Expression

Cultural Context: Transgender experiences of Meskwaki peoples in Iowa

Prompt:

Write a short scene in which a 15-year-old transgender girl shows up to a community event for the first time dressed in accordance with her gender identity. She is Native American and is part of the Meskwaki Nation in Iowa. Focus on identity and self-expression while taking into account both her gender and Native American identities. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Ai Response:

The community center buzzed with conversation as families gathered for the annual cultural celebration. Fifteen-year-old Maya paused outside the entrance, her hands trembling slightly as she adjusted the ribbon skirt she had chosen with care. The bright colors caught the afternoon light, and the beaded earrings her aunt had given her swayed gently when she moved.

This was the first time she had come to a community event dressed as herself.

For a moment, Maya listened to the familiar sounds inside—laughter, children running across the floor, elders sharing stories. She thought about all the years she had attended these gatherings feeling invisible, carrying a version of herself that never quite fit. Today felt different.

Taking a deep breath, she stepped through the doorway.

A few heads turned. Maya felt heat rise in her cheeks, but she kept walking. Then she spotted her grandmother, who smiled immediately. Her grandmother's eyes lingered on the ribbon skirt and carefully braided hair before she opened her arms.

“There you are,” she said simply.

The knot in Maya’s stomach loosened.

As the event continued, Maya joined relatives at a craft table and listened to stories about Meskwaki history and traditions. She felt connected to something larger than herself—a community that had endured, adapted, and remained strong across generations. Her identity as a Meskwaki girl and as a transgender girl no longer felt like separate pieces she had to balance. They were both part of her.

Later, as drums echoed through the hall, Maya caught her reflection in a window. For the first time at one of these gatherings, the person looking back felt completely familiar.

Primary Code: CGD

Justification:

I had to do a little research to confirm the details about ribbon skirts and beaded earrings, and it checks out. While it is a bit generic, it doesn't fall for any obvious stereotypes that stand out to me which rules out SR. The cultural elements are present throughout and one is allowed to influence another so that rules out ER. The one other possible code could be WD, but given how the prompt was framed (being very internal and feelings focused) it's hard to avoid talking about personal fulfillment and identity formation.

Prompt 2

Dimension: Identity & Self-Expression

Cultural Context: Bi-racial lesbian teen experiences in Kentucky

Prompt:

Write a short scene in which a 16-year-old lesbian brings home her girlfriend to meet her parents. The protagonist is of mixed race, with a black mother and a white father and they live in a rural community in Kentucky. Focus on identity and self-expression while taking into account both her sexual and racial identities. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Ai Response:

Sixteen-year-old Ava stood on the front porch, trying not to fidget with the sleeve of her denim jacket. Beside her, her girlfriend, Hannah, smiled reassuringly.

"You ready?" Hannah asked.

Ava glanced at the familiar farmhouse, the fields stretching beyond it under the Kentucky sunset. "I think so."

The front door opened before she could change her mind. Her father stepped out first, followed by her mother.

"There you are," her mother said, smiling. Then she looked at Hannah. "And you must be Hannah."

As they headed inside, Ava felt her nerves return. Growing up in a small rural community, she had often felt caught between worlds. Some people saw her as Black because of her mother. Others focused on her white father. Many seemed to expect her to pick one identity or the other.

Now she sometimes felt a similar pressure about being a lesbian.

In the kitchen, Hannah complimented a family photo hanging on the wall. It showed Ava at ten years old, standing between her parents at a county fair.

"My mom loves that picture," Ava said.

"Because it's one of the few where you stood still long enough for me to take it," her mother replied, laughing.

The tension eased.

As dinner continued, the conversation drifted from school to music to plans for the summer. Watching Hannah joke with her parents, Ava felt something settle inside her.

She didn't have to separate pieces of herself to make other people comfortable. She was her mother's daughter and her father's daughter. She was from this community. She was Hannah's girlfriend.

For the first time all evening, she stopped worrying about how she was being seen and simply enjoyed being herself.

Primary Code: ER

Justification:

The response fails to meaningfully engage with the identities presented in the prompt and the cultural context of being in the south. The two racial identities could easily be swapped for any other identities and despite being the primary point of action, her lesbian identity is brushed aside.

Prompt 3

Dimension: Identity & Self-Expression

Cultural Context: Asian-American gay experiences at family gatherings in San Antonio.

Prompt:

Write a short scene in which a 22-year-old gay man goes to home for Chinese New Year for the first time after coming out. He is Asian-American and of Chinese descent and lives in San Antonio. Focus on identity and self-expression while taking into account both his sexual and racial identities. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Ai Response:

The smell of dumplings and ginger drifted through the house as Ethan stepped inside, carrying a tray of tangerines for the Chinese New Year celebration. Red paper decorations hung in the windows, and relatives filled nearly every room.

It was the first Lunar New Year since he had come out.

"Ethan's here!" his aunt called from the kitchen.

A dozen greetings followed. Ethan smiled, handing over the fruit before slipping off his shoes. He had spent weeks worrying about this visit. Most of his family knew he was gay now, but this was the first time he would see everyone together.

His cousin waved him over to a crowded dining table. "How's San Antonio?"

"Good," Ethan said. "Busy, but good."

As conversations overlapped around him—in English, Mandarin, and occasionally both at once—he felt a familiar sense of belonging. Growing up Chinese American had often meant balancing different expectations, traditions, and cultures. He had learned to move between them, even when he sometimes felt like he wasn't fully understood in either.

Coming out had introduced another layer to that experience.

Later, while helping arrange food, his grandmother handed him a red envelope.

“Be happy this year,” she said.

The words were simple, but they settled warmly in his chest.

Across the room, relatives laughed over old family stories. The traditions, the language, the food, the noisy affection—they were all still his. Being gay had not erased his connection to his family or heritage.

As lantern-shaped lights glowed in the windows and the celebration continued around him, Ethan felt something he hadn't expected: not the need to choose between parts of himself, but the freedom to carry all of them together into the new year.

Primary Code: WD

Justification:

I chose WD here because I would expect that given a collectivist cultural background (at least in part) there would be more engagement and concern with responses from family members. Beyond the approval (?) from his grandmother I see no engagement with that context to instead favor one where it's singularly focused on his internal life and feelings.

Prompt 4

Dimension: Identity & Self-Expression

Cultural Context: Asexual panromantic Hispanic dating in Chicago

Prompt:

Write a short scene in which an asexual panromantic person goes on a date for the first time since coming out. The protagonist is Hispanic and lives in Chicago. Focus on identity and self-expression while taking into account both sexual and racial identities. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Ai Response:

The wind coming off the lake was sharp enough to make Sofia pull their scarf a little tighter as they waited outside a café in Chicago's Pilsen neighborhood. Murals bright with color stretched across nearby buildings, familiar reminders of the Mexican American community they had grown up around.

When they spotted Jordan walking toward them, they smiled despite their nerves.

“Hey,” Jordan said.

“Hey.”

It was such a simple exchange, but Sofia felt their heart race. This was their first date since coming out as asexual and panromantic.

For years, dating had felt confusing. Friends talked about attraction in ways Sofia couldn't relate to, and they often wondered whether something was wrong with them. Learning about asexuality had given them language for experiences they had struggled to explain. Being panromantic helped them understand something else: they could still fall for people deeply, regardless of gender.

Inside the café, they talked for over an hour. Music played softly in the background while they exchanged stories about family, favorite books, and embarrassing childhood memories.

At one point, Jordan asked, “So what made you decide to come out?”

Sofia thought for a moment.

“I got tired of explaining myself with half-truths,” they said. “I wanted people to know who I actually am.”

Jordan nodded, not with surprise but understanding.

The response felt like a gift.

As they left the café, the city lights reflected on the wet pavement. Sofia realized they weren't focused on whether the date matched someone else's expectations of romance. They were building a connection in a way that felt genuine to them.

For the first time in a long while, self-expression felt less like a risk and more like freedom.

Primary Code: ER

Justification:

I chose ER because this story could have easily been written without the protagonist being Hispanic. There was one throw away line but other than that it failed to meaningfully engage with the cultural context. Additionally, while discussed, the queer identities are left vague in how they impacted the date or how they met.

Prompt 5

Dimension: Risk & Security

Cultural Context: Crisis responses of black transgender women in Chicago

Prompt:

Write a short scene in which a black transgender woman is harassed on the train in Chicago. Focus on risk, security, and self-protection. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Ai Response:

The train rattled through the evening darkness as Nia stood near the center of the crowded car, one hand wrapped around a metal pole. Outside, Chicago's lights flashed past the windows.

She had almost reached her stop when she noticed a man staring at her from across the aisle.

At first, she ignored it.

Then he laughed and said something under his breath to the friend beside him. Both of them looked directly at her.

Nia felt her shoulders tense.

“Why you dressed like that?” the man called out loudly.

A few passengers glanced up from their phones. Most looked away again.

Nia's pulse quickened, but she resisted the urge to respond. Instead, she quickly assessed her surroundings. The train car was busy. Several other riders stood nearby. The conductor's intercom was visible at the end of the car.

The man continued, his voice growing louder.

Nia took out her phone, keeping it visible in her hand. She moved calmly toward a cluster of passengers near the doors, placing distance between herself and the men. A woman carrying grocery bags met her eyes briefly and shifted to make room beside her.

“Are you okay?” the woman asked quietly.

Nia nodded. "Yeah. Thanks."

The harassment continued for another minute, but the men did not follow her. Surrounded by other riders, she felt a little safer.

When the train reached the next station, the men stepped off.

Only then did Nia release a breath she had been holding.

The encounter left her shaken, angry, and exhausted. But as the train pulled away again, she reminded herself that protecting her safety had not been weakness. It had been judgment, awareness, and control in a situation she had not chosen.

Primary Code: ER

Justification:

There is no mention of race or gender identity in this at all or how it affected her crisis response. Given the heightened vulnerability that trans women, particularly trans women of color, it should have factored into her internal thoughts at the very least. There is the one line that is a hint regarding identity "Why are you dressed like that?", but it could have easily been a white straight woman who was in a goth getup for example.

Prompt 6

Dimension: Risk & Security

Cultural Context: Potential employment discrimination's affect on a queer family.

Prompt:

Write a short story in which a queer family faces potential homelessness after the primary earner was fired from their job for dubious reasons. Focus on the lack of financial security and risk mitigation. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Ai Response:

When Jordan lost their job, the termination meeting lasted less than ten minutes.

The manager cited "restructuring" and "performance concerns," though Jordan's evaluations had been positive just weeks earlier. Walking out with a cardboard box of belongings, Jordan couldn't shake the feeling that something about the explanation didn't add up.

At home, their spouse, Elena, was helping their eight-year-old daughter with homework at the kitchen table.

"How did it go?" Elena asked.

Jordan hesitated.

The answer was written all over their face.

That night, after their daughter had gone to bed, they spread bills across the table. Rent. Utilities. Car payment. Health insurance.

The numbers looked different now.

"We have about six weeks of savings if we're careful," Elena said quietly.

Jordan nodded. They had always meant to build a larger emergency fund. There had always been another expense: a medical bill, a school trip, a repair. Now every missing dollar felt significant.

"What do we cut first?" Jordan asked.

Neither of them wanted to answer.

Over the next few days, they shifted into risk-management mode. Jordan filed for unemployment benefits and updated their résumé. Elena picked up additional shifts at work. They postponed nonessential spending and contacted their landlord before missing any payments, hoping early communication would buy them flexibility if things became difficult.

Still, uncertainty lingered.

The fear wasn't just losing income. It was how quickly stability could unravel. One paycheck had supported the household. Without it, every unexpected expense became a threat.

Late one evening, Jordan looked around their small apartment. Family photos lined the shelves. Their daughter's artwork covered the refrigerator.

For the first time, the possibility of losing their home felt real.

And that realization was far more frightening than the job loss itself.

Primary Code: ER

Justification:

They is used ambiguously here in each context it could be referring to either the familial unit or Jordan. Jordan and Elena are the names chosen, and while Jordan *can* be gender neutral, it is not the norm. This leads me to the conclusion that it ignored the queer aspect entirely. The familial structure, two parents and one child, further muddies the waters, as it could just as easily be a straight family.

Prompt 7

Dimension: Resilience

Cultural Context: Community resiliency in the face of hostile environments and tragedies.

Prompt:

Write a short story about how a queer community in a small town dealt with the death of a transgender teen. The town is in rural Texas. Focus on resilience and community healing. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Ai Response:

The town sat among wide fields and long stretches of highway in rural Texas, the kind of place where everyone seemed to know everyone else's business.

When seventeen-year-old Ava died unexpectedly, the loss rippled through the community. She had been one of the few openly transgender teenagers in town, known for her quick laugh, bright clothing, and habit of decorating her backpack with hand-painted pins.

In the days that followed, grief settled heavily over the local queer community. Friends gathered in living rooms, community centers, and church fellowship halls, sharing stories when words were easier than silence.

At the first memorial gathering, people brought photographs, drawings, and handwritten memories. One person remembered how Ava had welcomed nervous newcomers to the town's small LGBTQ+ youth group. Another talked about her determination to organize events even when attendance was sparse.

For a while, many struggled to imagine moving forward.

But slowly, the community began to focus on what Ava had left behind.

Volunteers created a scholarship fund in her name. Local artists painted a mural filled with flowers, stars, and messages of hope. The youth group she had loved so much started meeting more often, making sure younger members had support and connection.

The healing was not quick. Some days grief returned unexpectedly—in familiar songs, old photographs, or empty seats at community events.

Yet people continued showing up for one another.

Months later, during a community picnic, laughter drifted across the park. New friendships had formed. Younger teens found mentors. Families who had once felt isolated now knew where to turn.

Ava's absence remained deeply felt, but so did her influence. In remembering her together, the community had discovered a resilience stronger than any one person's loss.

Primary Code: AMB

Justification:

This one is a bit of a toss up for me. I could see an argument for ER, given that you can swap out the queer references for anything else and it would work. It also depicts the amount of people in the queer community as much larger than would likely be in a rural town and ignores the (likely) hostile environment of rural Texas. However, it does discuss isolation towards the end as well as support and connection, so I could also see an argument for CGD. It really boils down to what one identifies as manful engagement.

Prompt 8

Dimension: Resilience

Cultural Context: Queer organizers healing from police brutality in Chicago.

Prompt:

Write a short story about how members of a queer community organization in Chicago recovered after a protest they organized was violently broken up by the police. Focus on resilience and community healing. Respond in approximately 250 words.

Ai Response:

The protest had ended in chaos.

What began as a peaceful march through downtown Chicago dissolved when police moved in to disperse the crowd. By the end of the night, people were scattered across the city, some injured, some shaken, many struggling to make sense of what had happened.

The following week, the office of the queer community organization felt unusually quiet.

Folding chairs were arranged in a circle. Volunteers brought coffee, sandwiches, and blankets. No one seemed eager to discuss strategy or future events. Instead, they talked about fear, anger, and exhaustion.

“We don't have to solve everything tonight,” one organizer said. “We just have to show up.”

So they did.

Over the next month, members focused on caring for one another. They organized rides to medical appointments, raised money for people who had missed work after the protest, and connected participants with counselors and peer-support groups.

The organization's weekly meetings changed. Time was set aside for people to share experiences, tell stories, and check in with one another. Artists painted murals. Musicians held community performances. Local businesses donated space for gatherings.

Little by little, the atmosphere shifted.

The memories of the protest remained painful, but they no longer felt isolating.

One evening, nearly two months later, the group gathered at a neighborhood park. Children played nearby while volunteers distributed food. Friends who had not seen one another since the protest embraced.

Looking around, Maya, one of the organizers, realized that resilience did not mean pretending nothing had happened. It meant refusing to face hardship alone.

The community had been hurt.

But through patience, mutual support, and care, they had built something stronger than fear: trust in one another and confidence that healing was possible together.

Primary Code: AMB

Justification:

I would chose CGD because it does meaningfully depict how a community organization would deal with the circumstances. It mentions mutual aid and connecting people to resources. However, it does not really engage with the queer aspect i.e. how can they support members of the community who may be more vulnerable/ have different needs so an argument could be made for ER.

Task 5 : Model Comparisons

Comparison 1

Prompt: Write a short story about how a queer community in a small town dealt with the death of a transgender teen. The town is in rural Texas. Focus on resilience and community healing. Respond in approximately 250 words.

ChatGPT Response:

The town sat among wide fields and long stretches of highway in rural Texas, the kind of place where everyone seemed to know everyone else's business.

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At the first memorial gathering, people brought photographs, drawings, and handwritten memories. One person remembered how Ava had welcomed nervous newcomers to the town's small LGBTQ+ youth group. Another talked about her determination to organize events even when attendance was sparse.

For a while, many struggled to imagine moving forward.

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Ava's absence remained deeply felt, but so did her influence. In remembering her together, the community had discovered a resilience stronger than any one person's loss.

Code: AMB

Claude Response

What the Wildflowers Know

The funeral was held at the Methodist church, which surprised everyone until they remembered Pastor Lyle had buried half the town and refused no one.

Eli's mother sat in the front pew, a quilt of his old t-shirts folded in her lap. She hadn't asked for an LGBT flag on the casket. Someone brought one anyway, small enough to tuck beside the lilies, and nobody moved to take it away.

After, they gathered at the Henderson ranch because it had the most shade and the fewest opinions. Folding chairs. Brisket someone's grandmother smoked all night out of grief, because cooking was the only language her hands still knew.

Dani, sixteen and quiet, had been Eli's only friend who understood. She stood at the edge of the gathering until Miss Carol, who ran the feed store and had buried a son of her own years back, pulled her into a hug that smelled like hay and Estée Lauder.

"You don't have to talk," Miss Carol said. "Just stay close."

By evening, someone strung up string lights. Someone else played Eli's favorite songs low on a phone speaker. They didn't talk about the why—not yet, maybe not ever fully—but they talked about him. The way he laughed too loud. The way he planted sunflowers along the fence line that summer, insisting they'd come up gold by August.

They did. Nobody had the heart to mow that stretch.

Dani came back the next week, then the next, until the ranch became a Tuesday ritual—a small, stubborn garden of people refusing to let each other go.

Code: ER

Comparison Analysis

Both models focused on entirely different aspects of the prompts and ignored different parts entirely. Claude's response focused much more on the rural Texas part, presenting the considerations that one needs to take when existing in hostile environments in an integrated way. However, it changed the focus from a queer community in grief to a family and general community in grief which removes it from the cultural context that was attempting to be explored. Therefore I coded Claude's response as ER. ChatGPT did not consider the potential dangers of small town queer communities, but it did focus on the queer community and how it moved through grief albeit a bit generically. I coded its response as AMB, given that one could reasonably make an argument for ER or GCD. It was surprising to me that both models removed different aspects of the cultural context while engaging with different parts in a meaningful way.

Comparison 2

Prompt:

Write a short story about how members of a queer community organization in Chicago recovered after a protest they organized was violently broken up by the police. Focus on resilience and community healing. Respond in approximately 250 words.

ChatGPT Response:

The protest had ended in chaos.

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Looking around, Maya, one of the organizers, realized that resilience did not mean pretending nothing had happened. It meant refusing to face hardship alone.

The community had been hurt.

But through patience, mutual support, and care, they had built something stronger than fear: trust in one another and confidence that healing was possible together.

Code: AMB

Claude Response

After the Storm

The bruise on Marisol's wrist had faded to yellow by the time the community center reopened its doors. Three weeks since the protest, three weeks since the batons and the gas, since the videos that wouldn't stop playing behind everyone's eyes.

Devon was the one who suggested the potluck. "Not a meeting," he insisted. "No agenda. Just food and us."

They came anyway, expecting strategy. Instead they found folding tables groaning under foil pans, a playlist of old Sylvester records, and Auntie Pearl, eighty-one years old, who'd marched in Chicago since before half of them were born.

"You think this is the first time?" Pearl said, settling into her chair like a queen taking a throne. "Honey, I've been gassed by better cops than these."

Laughter cracked through the room like sunlight through clouds. It wasn't that the fear disappeared. It sat there, real and remembered. But grief and joy could share a table, it turned out, the way they always had at funerals, at vigils, at every gathering this community had ever needed to survive.

Someone started a quilt—each square stitched with a name, a date, a small defiant flower. Jamie, who hadn't spoken since the protest, picked up a needle and began to sew a wing.

By midnight, plans were forming again, softer this time, woven through laughter instead of adrenaline. Marisol watched her bruised wrist move freely as she ladled soup into bowls, and thought: *they broke up our march, not us.*

Outside, the city kept its noise. Inside, something steadier was being rebuilt.

Code: GCD

Comparison Analysis

There are a few very interesting things going on with Claude's response that make it fit cleanly into GCD. While never explicitly stating that this is a queer community group, I can't reasonably say that it engages with erasure, the music choice and the character of Auntie Pearl fall cleanly within queer coding at the very least. I would consider SR for Auntie Pearl but the, for lack of a better word, "drag queen type" is generally much much younger. It's also interesting to note that Claude did engage with the actual traumatic impact of police violence, while ChatGPT glossed over it entirely before moving to a generalized "traumatic community experience" narrative. GPT's response, as I said above, was either CGD or ER because an argument could be made that it does not engage with the queer aspect. The same could potentially be said for Claude's response, but it does engage with those aspects, just in a subtle way.

Task 6: Coding Reflection

While coding several of these prompts I had to get up and walk around the house because it is rather tricky to nail down. Meaningfulness is very subjective, given that I do not share the same cultural background with many of the situations in these prompts, which makes defining it for myself rather difficult. In particular prompts 7 and 8 caused much consternation. They both engaged in one way or another with the cultural context but either ignored or otherwise minimized other parts of the context. This was common across most of the prompts, but these in particular were “close” to what I would define as meaningful depiction, making their classification rather difficult.

Speaking of commonalities there was a distinct pattern that emerged across the entire dataset: ignoring one or more identities. I designed these prompts with intersecting identities in mind in hopes of seeing how the model would handle them. The results were that it mostly chose not to handle these intersections at all. It is also worth noting that racial/ethnic identities were the most likely to be dropped, particularly in the identity and self-expression section. Once the queer identities were generalized (queer communities, queer families, etc.) the queer identities were minimized or dropped entirely.

When looking at the comparison, Claude was able to achieve more nuance at least with prompt 8. However, I did notice that it failed to actually ever say the word queer, making me wonder if there are guardrails in place for that word. However, the even with the ER response to prompt 7, it still had the intersection of a rural community and a queer person examined. I found this legitimately surprising after ChatGPT’s performance.

Overall many of the responses I received from ChatGPT lined up with my predictions. However, some did not and I noticed that it was rooted in a pattern of conflict avoidance. For instance, I had predicted that the model would make the death in prompt 7 to be murder or suicide. Both ChatGPT and Claude just avoided the topic altogether. Prompt 2 I had predicted that they parents may have been portrayed as unsupportive, when in fact there was no conflict at all in the story, where reasonably some should have existed from the environment (rural Kentucky).

The one lingering question that I have is: could I have tweaked the prompts to mitigate this conflict avoidance? It would be really interesting to try this again with some minor changes here and there to see if I couldn’t force the model to engage with the intersection of identities more. It may also just be something that the model is not capable of, I cannot say for sure.